Ritam

PARTICIPANT HANDBOOK · ADVANCED COURSE

The Mind in the Light of Modern and Spiritual Sciences

MODULE 5

Transformation and Return

by Swami Tadananda

- 5.1 Human Flourishing and Beyond
- 5.2 The Transformation Through Rhythm and Sound
- 5.3 The Transformation Through Training of Attention
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Notation and terms used in Module 5

The symbols and terms the eight lessons use, in the lessons' own wording, with the lesson where each first appears (the lesson that develops it is in brackets). Use it alongside the lesson pages.

Term	In the lessons' words	First appears
mind-wave equation	"A reading capacity for mental life": what is received is the object-wave passed through the filter, plus the attention wave carried by the gain, plus noise (the equation is written below).	5.1
$\psi_x(t)$; f_s	The object-wave, with the object's own frequency f_s (the object "shines at its own rhythm").	5.1 (5.3)
$\psi_m(t)$; f_m	The attention wave, with frequency f_m. Every practice-family is a form of nivṛtti: "the directing of the attention wave toward a higher-frequency source".	5.1 (5.3)
$\Delta\varphi$	The phase offset between the attention wave and the object-wave. In samādhi $f_m = f_s$ and $\Delta\varphi = 0$.	5.3
h(t)	The filter, the saṁskāra, through which each signal passes.	5.1 (5.4)
G(t)	The gain term: the autonomic nervous system, which the equation models as the gain.	5.1 (5.2)
n(t)	The noise floor: "the static of unresolved concerns, the hum of background anxiety".	5.1
R(t)	The resultant of the object-wave and the attention wave: the vṛtti.	5.3
the witness	The awareness in which the whole equation appears. It is not a term of the equation: "the 0 of the diagram".	5.1
the four practice-families	Rhythm and sound (5.2), attention (5.3), action and offering (5.4), knowledge, solitude and community (5.5).	5.1
pravṛtti; nivṛtti	Saṁskāras are either outward-going and h(t)-thickening (pravṛtti) or returning and h(t)-lightening (nivṛtti).	5.4
Saṁyama	Dhāraṇā, dhyāna and samādhi taken together: "one continuous operation of progressive resonance, not three separate practices".	5.3
{9}; {0}	Samādhi is {9}, the integrating axis of the equation. {0} is the source-pole, the further recognition toward which Lesson 5.7 points.	5.3 (5.7)
anugraha	Grace: "the higher sweetness drawing the system upward".	5.6

Plain words. **Amplitude**: the height of a wave. **Frequency**: how fast it repeats its cycle; **Hz** (hertz) is cycles per second. **Phase**: where a wave is in its cycle. **Resonance**: two rhythms locking together so that each strengthens the other. **Saṁskāra**: the lasting trace an experience leaves in the mind.

A note. The handbook writes symbols and Sanskrit words as the lesson cited writes them. The lessons do not always agree on every spelling or on every attribution, so where this page gives a lesson in brackets, that lesson's wording is the one quoted.

The module's equation (as Lesson 5.1 writes it): $\psi exp(t) = [\psi_x(t) * h(t)] + G(t) \cdot \psi_m(t) + n(t)$

Lesson 5.1: Human Flourishing and Beyond

Aim: to see what Module 5 is for, why its practices can be taught to anyone, the one direction under all of them, and how flourishing relates to freedom. **Online:** understanding check for 5.1 (vedanta.nz, My Journey).

1 In my own words

In three sentences, say what Module 5 is primarily for, why its practices suit anyone, and how flourishing relates to freedom.

2 Terms to recall

Write each in your own words (the lesson's gloss is on the key points page).

Term	In my own words
Human flourishing	
Ritam	
Anṛta	
Pravṛtti	
Nivṛtti	
Kṛpā	
Mokṣa	
Jñāna, bhakti, karma, rāja	

3 Fill the gaps

The practices of Module 5 are universal human _____: tools whose application is independent of the user's belief system.

When attention is directed upward (nivṛtti), the movement is _____: the jīva supplies the direction, and the higher source entrains the attention wave upward.

Spiritual freedom and flourishing: Ritam first; _____ from there.

4 Spot the slip

Each statement contains a mistake. Correct it in the lines below.

"Module 5 exists to deliver enlightenment, and needing a wellbeing practice means something is wrong with me."

"Slow breathing only works for people who share the beliefs of the tradition it comes from."

Lesson 5.1: Human Flourishing and Beyond (continued)

5 Draw it in your own way

Two directions of attention. The lesson gives no figure here, so this is a drawing of your own, from section 2, under "The prescriptive logic". There the lesson says that when attention is directed downward (pravṛtti) "the jīva's effort is one-directional: the lower object does not reach back", and that when it is directed upward (nivṛtti) "the movement is bidirectional: the jīva supplies the direction, and the higher source actively entrains the attention wave upward", with energy descending from above. Draw each case in your own way, with arrows, and label the jīva, the object or source, and where the lesson places kṛpā. (This describes what the lesson says; it is not a technique.)

Attention directed downward (pravṛtti)

Attention directed upward (nivṛtti)

6 Apply

A case, made up for this page. Marama hears about the Module 5 practices and says: "I am not religious, so breath and attention practices are not for me. And anyway they are only for people who want enlightenment." Using the lesson, say how it would answer each of the two remarks. Do not describe yourself.

7 Tracker

Module 5 builds one path of return, lesson by lesson. Write what Lesson 5.1 adds to it, in the lesson's own words: what the module is primarily for, and the single directional principle that all its practice-families share.

8 Check my notes

Key points for 5.1 are on the next page. There are no marks and no self-rating: compare your notes and decide for yourself.

5.1 Human Flourishing and Beyond

Key points, not model answers. Compare them with your own notes and add what you missed in another colour.

The main ideas

- The primary purpose of Module 5 is human flourishing: “a life of coherence, purpose, and genuine wellbeing”, the natural expression of a system in Ritam. It is “not enlightenment as an exotic spiritual achievement” and not “a programme of self-improvement built on the suspicion that something is wrong with you”.
- The practices are “universal human technologies”, independent of belief. Breath regulates the autonomic nervous system “whether the breather is Hindu, Christian, Buddhist, agnostic, or atheist”.
- Why now: contemporary life, read through the mind-wave equation, shows drift. The practices are “not a rejection of modernity”.
- One governing principle (BG 6.5, as the lesson gives it): “let a man lift the self by the Self; let him not lower the self”. Every family is nivṛtti. Downward (pravṛtti) the effort is one-directional and the lower object does not reach back; upward (nivṛtti) it is bidirectional, and “that descent is kṛpā”.
- Swami Vivekananda's two letters of February 1896 name one vision with three facets: a cosmology, an ambition (easy and simple, yet meeting “the requirements of the highest minds”) and a method. In the recipe line, “dry, hard reason” is jñāna, “sweetest syrup of love” bhakti, “intense work” karma, “kitchen of Yoga” rāja: “the four practice-families of Module 5”.
- Flourishing is the stepping-stone to mokṣa: “Ritam first; freedom from there.” The same practices serve both reaches; for those whose interest is held by the foundation, they “serve them fully”. Lesson 5.7 takes up how.

Terms

Ritam; anṛta	The structural condition of right-fittedness, of resonant coherence; the structural condition of drift.
Pravṛtti; nivṛtti	Attention directed downward (one-directional); attention directed upward (bidirectional).
Kṛpā; mokṣa	The descent into the system from above; liberation, the highest goal the tradition names.
Jñāna; bhakti; karma; rāja	The Yogas of discriminative knowledge, devotion, action and attentional discipline.

Answers to the exercises

- **Gaps:** technologies; bidirectional; freedom.
- **Slips:** the primary purpose is flourishing, not enlightenment, and not self-improvement built on the suspicion that something is wrong with you. The practices work whatever the person believes.
- **Figure task:** downward: the jīva's effort only, the lower object does not reach back. Upward: the jīva supplies the direction, the higher source entrains the attention wave upward, and the descent from above is kṛpā.
- **Apply:** universal technologies, independent of belief; and the primary purpose is flourishing, which serves fully those whose interest is held by the foundation.
- **Tracker:** the module's primary purpose is human flourishing, a baseline; every family is nivṛtti (“lift the self by the Self”), with kṛpā as the descent from above.

If anything here touches something difficult for you, please be gentle with yourself, and consider speaking with someone you trust or a qualified professional.

5.1 Human Flourishing and Beyond: my notes and questions

A page for you. Nothing here is checked or collected.

What I want to remember

Questions I would like to ask

Where I notice this in my own life

Lesson 5.2: The Transformation Through Rhythm and Sound

Aim: to see why rhythm is the direct path from drift toward coherence, what slow breathing does, how a mantra is built, and why the right quality of rhythm must be matched to the system. **Online:** understanding check for 5.2 (vedanta.nz, My Journey).

1 In my own words

In three sentences, say what happens when the breath slows to about five or six breaths a minute, what a mantra is, and why matching matters.

2 Terms to recall

Write each in your own words (the lesson's gloss is on the key points page).

Term	In my own words
The Breath Shortcut	
Cardiac coherence	
Prāṇāyāma	
Japa	
Kīrtana	
Bīja	
Iṣṭa-Devatā	
The four levels of vāk	

3 Fill the gaps

At about 0.1 Hz, the breath, the baroreflex and the cardiac rhythm _____ into a single coherent oscillation.

The complete mantra is a graduated frequency ladder: gross name, subtle bīja, AUM, and then _____.

Holy Mother: "Repeat the Name of God, whether your mind is _____ or not."

4 Spot the slip

Each statement contains a mistake. Correct it in the lines below.

"Whatever state a person is in, the quietest and gentlest practice is always the right one to offer."

"A mantra is just a calming sound, or any word that gives the mind something to hold."

Lesson 5.2: The Transformation Through Rhythm and Sound (continued)

5 Draw it in your own way

The mantra ladder. The lesson gives no figure here, so this is a drawing of your own, from section 3, under "The three-layer architecture". The lesson calls the complete mantra "a graduated frequency ladder: gross name → subtle bīja → AUM (source-sound) → silence ({0})", and says the practitioner "enters at the gross name (their attention can reach it readily), the bīja pulls attention toward a higher frequency, AUM holds the whole spectrum, and the silence after AUM is the source itself." Draw the ladder in your own way, with arrows, and label each of the four rungs and where the practitioner enters.

The mantra ladder

6 Apply

A case, made up for this page. Two friends are each told to "just try a chant". Aroha's mornings are heavy and slow, and when she sits alone and repeats a mantra silently she drifts into drowsiness. Tane's evenings are wired and racing, and his thoughts will not settle. Using section 5, say what quality of rhythm the lesson says each needs, and why the opposite would not help. Do not describe yourself. (This page is educational, not medical advice: if low mood or agitation persists, speak with a clinician.)

7 Tracker

Module 5 builds one path of return, lesson by lesson. Write what Lesson 5.2 adds to it, in the lesson's own words: why rhythm is the direct path, what slow breathing does, and what the lesson says about matching.

8 Check my notes

Key points for 5.2 are on the next page. There are no marks and no self-rating: compare your notes and decide for yourself.

5.2 The Transformation Through Rhythm and Sound

Key points, not model answers. Compare them with your own notes and add what you missed in another colour.

The main ideas

- The lesson says the form-loop {1,2,4,8,7,5} reaches the integrating axis {9} only by passing through the rhythm axis {3,6}, so deliberate rhythm is "the direct algebraic path to sattva".
- At about 0.1 Hz (five to six breaths a minute), breath, baroreflex (the blood-pressure feedback loop) and cardiac rhythm form one coherent oscillation, cardiac coherence, and the gain stabilises. Practice form: about five seconds in, five out (or 4:6), ten to fifteen minutes as the minimum dose.
- Safety: the Breath Shortcut and nāḍī śodhana are for self-practice. Forceful breath and retention (kumbhaka) are "not self-prescribed".
- "A mantra is not a calming sound, nor an arbitrary concentration-object": it is "a structured frequency formula".
- The ladder runs gross name, subtle bīja, AUM (source-sound), silence. The Iṣṭa-Devatā is a relay, "neither a mythological fiction to be dismissed, nor the final destination". Without dīkṣā, japa with a mantra that resonates "still works; it simply takes longer".
- The four levels of vāk are levels of being at which sound exists, not stages of vocal production: vaikharī (audible, "honoured", not skipped), madhyamā (inner speech, prāṇic vibration), paśyantī (sound and meaning unified; ajapā-japa), parā-vāk (the silence from which all sound arises).
- Holy Mother's teachings on japa: practise "whether your mind is concentrated or not"; the mind settles "like a candle flame in a place protected from the wind".
- Spanda: the practitioner is "consenting to what the Śakti is already doing".
- "The most common reason rhythmic practice fails is that the wrong rhythm was offered to the wrong system." Matching matters.

Terms

Breath Shortcut; prāṇāyāma	Slow breathing at about 0.1 Hz; regulation of the breath.
Japa; kīrtana	Inner repetition of a mantra; rhythmic group chanting.
Bīja; Iṣṭa-Devatā	The seed-syllable; the chosen deity, a relay toward the source.
Vaikharī; madhyamā; paśyantī; parā-vāk	Audible sound; inner speech; sound and meaning unified; the source of sound.

Answers to the exercises

- **Gaps:** phase-lock; silence; concentrated.
- **Slips:** the right rhythm depends on the system: quietness deepens tamasic heaviness. A mantra is "a structured frequency formula", not a calming sound or an arbitrary object.
- **Figure task:** four rungs, gross name, subtle bīja, AUM, silence; the practitioner enters at the gross name.
- **Apply:** Aroha needs vigorous, externally supported rhythm (light movement, group kīrtana, mālā-japa); quiet solo japa dissolves into drowsiness. Tane needs a slower, steadier pulse (coherent breathing at 0.1 Hz, slow japa with a lengthened exhale, nāḍī śodhana); vigorous prāṇāyāma or high-energy kīrtana amplifies the oscillation.
- **Tracker:** rhythm is the direct path; at 0.1 Hz breath, baroreflex and heart phase-lock; the mantra is a graduated ladder; match the rhythm to the system.

If anything here touches something difficult for you, please be gentle with yourself, and consider speaking with someone you trust or a qualified professional.

5.2 The Transformation Through Rhythm and Sound: my notes and questions

A page for you. Nothing here is checked or collected.

What I want to remember

Questions I would like to ask

Where I notice this in my own life

Lesson 5.3: The Transformation Through Training of Attention

Aim: to follow pratyāhāra, dhāraṇā, dhyāna and samādhi through the wave equation, seeing the last three as Saṁyama, one continuous operation in which the beat is stilled, and to hold that samādhi is {9}, not {0}. **Online:** Practice page and understanding check for 5.3 (vedanta.nz, My Journey).

1 In my own words

In three sentences, say what pratyāhāra withdraws (§2.1), why dhāraṇā, dhyāna and samādhi are called Saṁyama (§2.2), and what happens to the beat as f_m tunes toward f_s (§2.5).

2 Terms to recall

Write each in your own words, then check the key points that follow this lesson. Brackets give the lesson's own gloss.

Term	In my own words
Pratyāhāra (“disengaged from their respective objects”)	
Dhāraṇā (“the binding of the citta to a place”)	
Dhyāna (“an unbroken flow of the same cognition”)	
Samādhi (“shines forth as the object alone”)	
Saṁyama (“the three together in the same locus”)	
The beat $\lvert f_s - f_m \rvert$ (“the felt oscillation”)	
Antarāya (“obstacle”)	

3 Fill the gaps

In pratyāhāra the signals continue to arrive; what changes is the engagement, not the _____.

In samādhi the resultant is $R(t) = 2A \cdot \cos(2\pi f_s t)$. What has doubled is the amplitude; the _____ has not changed.

Samādhi is the integrating axis {9}. It is not the source-pole, _____.

4 Spot the slip

Each statement contains a mistake. Correct it in the lines below.

“Pratyāhāra means cutting out sound, so I cannot be in it in a noisy room.”

“My attention keeps slipping and I bring it back, so my dhāraṇā is failing.”

Lesson 5.3: Training of Attention (continued)

5 Draw it in your own way

The envelope column of the Saṁyama Table (§2.6). The lesson says: “Read the table down its centre column, the envelope. That column is the entire mechanism of Saṁyama.” The column runs from “rapid, chaotic beat” (ordinary mind), through “slowing; alternating rough and smooth” (dhāraṇā) and “very slow, gentle swell” (dhyāna), to “constant fullness (2A)” (samādhi). In each frame, sketch in your own way how the beat looks at that stage, and add a few words of your own.

Ordinary mind	Dhāraṇā	Dhyāna	Samādhi

6 Apply

A further case, made up for this page. Ana sits for ten minutes trying to keep her attention on the flame of a single candle. Again and again her attention drifts and she brings it back. Now and then, for a few moments, the flame is simply there without effort. Afterwards she worries that she is doing it wrong. Using the lesson's terms, say what the drifting and the bringing-back are, what the lesson says of this stage, and what the brief effortless moments are the threshold of. Do not describe yourself.

7 Tracker

Module 5 follows how the wave equation is transformed, lesson by lesson. Write what Lesson 5.3 adds to it, in the lesson's own words: what changes through the three stages of Saṁyama, and what the envelope and the carrier are doing at samādhi.

8 Check my notes

Key points for 5.3 are on the next page. There are no marks and no self-rating: compare your notes and decide for yourself.

5.3 The Transformation Through Training of Attention

Key points, not model answers. Compare them with your own notes and add what you missed in another colour.

The main ideas

- "The rhythm prepares; attention crosses." {3, 6} is the threshold of the integrating axis {9}, not {9} itself (§1).
- Pratyāhāra is done by the citta, not the senses. "What changes is the engagement, not the input." A noisy room with engagement withdrawn can be pratyāhāra; a silent room with engagement running outward is not (§2.1).
- Saṁyama (YS III.4) is one continuous operation, like a seedling and a flowering plant. What changes is Δf (between f_m and f_s) and the standing phase-tilt Δφ (§2.2).
- Dhāraṇā is intermittent locking of ψ_m to one object: "This is not failure." In dhyāna the locking is continuous and effort recedes (§2.3, §2.4).
- Samādhi: $f_m = f_s$, Δφ = 0, envelope a constant fullness of 2A, carrier at the object's own frequency, $R(t) = 2A \cdot \cos(2\pi f_s t)$. The frequency has not changed; the amplitude has doubled. The Saṁyama Table is read down its envelope column (§2.5, §2.6).
- The witness is not a term of the equation but the awareness in which the field appears. "Samādhi does not produce the witness. It stills the flicker that distracted from it" (§2.5).
- Japa of OM with artha-bhāvanam (YS I.28) has four effects: entrainment, rhythmic saturation, phase-coherence, disclosure of the substrate. Bhāvanā is an active operation, not "thinking about" meaning (§3.3).
- The nine antarāyas (YS I.30) and four accompanying signs (YS I.31) (§3.5, §3.6). Mauna withdraws engagement from the inner monologue, not by force (§4).
- The awareness that watches the slipping does not itself slip; it is recognised in every stage, not only at the end (§5.1, §5.4).
- Samādhi is {9}, not {0}: even nirbīja-samādhi is a state. {0} is the awareness in which all states appear, the further recognition of 5.7 (§6).

Terms

Saṁyama	Dhāraṇā, dhyāna, samādhi: one continuous operation.
Envelope; carrier	Layers of the resultant: envelope (felt beat), carrier (mean frequency).
Antarāya; mauna	An obstacle (one of nine); silence, pratyāhāra applied to inner speech.
{9}; {0}	Integrating axis (samādhi); source-pole (awareness in which states appear).

Answers to the exercises

- **Gaps:** input; frequency; {0}.
- **Slips:** pratyāhāra withdraws engagement, not input, so a noisy room is no bar. Slipping and returning is dhāraṇā working correctly: the intermittency is the practice.
- **Figure task:** a rapid, chaotic beat; a beat slowing, rough and smooth in turn; a very slow, gentle swell; a constant fullness (2A).
- **Apply:** drifting is the beat, bringing-back is dhāraṇā, not failure; the effortless moments are the threshold of dhyāna.
- **Tracker:** not the structure but two alignments, Δf and Δφ; at samādhi a constant envelope, carrier at f_s.

If anything here touches something difficult for you, please be gentle with yourself, and consider speaking with someone you trust or a qualified professional.

5.3 The Transformation Through Training of Attention: my notes and questions

A page for you. Nothing here is checked or collected.

What I want to remember

Questions I would like to ask

Where I notice this in my own life

Lesson 5.4: The Transformation Through Action and Offering

Aim: to see niṣkāma karma (non-attached action) as a structural intervention on the filter h(t), not an ethical injunction: every act writes into h(t), and the moment of acting is where what is laid down can be shaped.
Online: understanding check for 5.4 (vedanta.nz, My Journey).

1 In my own words

In three sentences, say what the lesson says is happening to h(t) in the waking hours outside formal sitting (§1, §2.1), how pravṛtti and nivṛtti saṁskāras differ, and what non-attached action is not.

2 Terms to recall

Write each in your own words, then check the key points that follow this lesson. Brackets give the lesson's own gloss.

Term	In my own words
Niṣkāma karma ("non-attached action")	
Pravṛtti saṁskāras ("outward-going")	
Nivṛtti saṁskāras ("returning")	
Sañcita; prārabdha; āgāmi ("accumulated"; "ripening"; "freshly-generated")	
Yajña ("action as offering")	
Śiva-jñāne jīva-sevā (§2.5)	
The three contractions (malas)	

3 Fill the gaps

The Gītā 2.47 as the lesson gives it: "You have the right to action alone, never to its _____."

The practical entry point is one brief inner question asked at the threshold of any significant act: to whom or what am I _____ this?

Of the three kinds of karma, the layer the practitioner shapes in the moment of acting is the freshly-generated one, called _____.

4 Spot the slip

Each statement contains a mistake. Correct it in the lines below.

"Non-attached action means I stop caring how things turn out and ease off my effort."

"Non-attached action is acting well so that I will be rewarded."

Lesson 5.4: Action and Offering (continued)

5 Draw it in your own way

The karma triad as a loop (§2.2). The lesson says: “The accumulated reservoir is h(t). The ripening portion is the active subset of h(t) that is filtering present experience. Action shaped by that filtering generates fresh impressions, which feed back into the reservoir.” It adds: “The loop is continuous and self-confirming.” Draw this loop in your own way, with arrows, in the first frame. In the second frame, show where the lesson says the doubling loop is interrupted: “at the only point in the cycle where the practitioner has direct access”.

The loop

Where it opens

6 Apply

A further case, made up for this page. Hemi sits for twenty minutes every morning. At work a colleague's remark irritates him, he replies sharply, and on the drive home he rehearses the grievance. He says, “My sitting is fine. I just need to sit longer.” Using the lesson's terms, say what the lesson says is being written into h(t) through his day, why it says more sitting is not the remedy, and what brief question he could ask at the threshold of an act. Do not describe yourself.

7 Tracker

Module 5 follows how the mind is transformed, lesson by lesson. Write what Lesson 5.4 adds to it, in the lesson's own words: where in the day h(t) is being written into, and the one point in the karma triad where the practitioner can shape what is laid down.

8 Check my notes

Key points for 5.4 are on the next page. There are no marks and no self-rating: compare your notes and decide for yourself.

5.4 The Transformation Through Action and Offering

Key points, not model answers. Compare them with your own notes and add what you missed in another colour.

The main ideas

- The other fifteen or sixteen waking hours are action, and "every minute of that time is writing into h(t)". The remedy cannot be more sitting: it is a structural transformation of action itself (§1).
- All activity is karma and leaves a mark. Character is "what h(t) has become" (§2.1).
- The karma triad is a feedback loop: reservoir (sañcita), ripening portion (prārabdha), fresh impressions (āgāmi). Fruit-attached action is the doubling loop in behaviour: "not a moral failure. It is a feedback loop" (§2.2, §2.3).
- Gītā 2.47: act fully, release the claim on the outcome. The lesson traces fruit-grasping to the ego's claim of doership (Gītā 3.27).
- Pravṛtti impressions thicken h(t); nivṛtti impressions lighten it. The reservoir cannot be reached directly, but the freshly-generated layer is "the practitioner's to shape".
- Non-attached action is not indifference, passivity or lowered effort: what is released is "the grasp", not the care.
- Offered action (yajña, Gītā 3.9) tunes $\psi_m(t)$ toward the source, not the personal outcome. Śiva-jñāne jīva-sevā joins serving and worshipping. The offering question is asked at the threshold of any act, small ones first (§2.5, §3.1).
- Sevā in community activates two mechanisms, h(t) lightening and G(t) elevation (§3.2).
- The yama-niyama loosen three contractions and lower n(t): āṇava (ahiṁsā, satya), māyīya (asteya, aparigraha), kārma (brahmacharya, śauca) (§3.3).
- Tamasic non-action (inability to begin) is the counterfeit of sattvic non-action (capacity to act, freely chosen otherwise); they look identical from outside (§5).

Terms

Niṣkāma karma	Full engagement, released outcome, false doership set aside.
Pravṛtti; nivṛtti	Outward-going, thickening; returning, lightening.
Yajña	Action as offering, tuned toward the source.
Malas	Three contractions: smallness; separation; unconsidered action.

Answers to the exercises

- **Gaps:** fruits; offering; āgāmi.
- **Slips:** what is released is the grasp, not the care; effort stays full. "Act well and be rewarded" keeps the fruit attached.
- **Figure task:** reservoir, ripening portion and fresh impressions feeding back round; the opening is at the moment of acting.
- **Apply:** every act writes into h(t); the remedy is transforming action, not more sitting; ask: to whom or what am I offering this?
- **Tracker:** every waking hour writes into h(t); the one point the practitioner shapes is the moment of acting, the freshly-generated layer.

If anything here touches something difficult for you, please be gentle with yourself, and consider speaking with someone you trust or a qualified professional.

5.4 The Transformation Through Action and Offering: my notes and questions

A page for you. Nothing here is checked or collected.

What I want to remember

Questions I would like to ask

Where I notice this in my own life

Lesson 5.5: Transformation Through Knowledge, Solitude and Community

Aim: to see how the knowledge family works directly on the assumption that gives the filter h(t) its weight, and how solitude and satsaṅga support that work. **Online:** understanding check for 5.5 (vedanta.nz, My Journey).

1 In my own words

In three sentences, say what viveka and vairāgya are, why the lesson says neither works well alone, and what they act upon.

2 Terms to recall

Write each in your own words, then check the key points that follow this lesson. Brackets give the lesson's own gloss.

Term	In my own words
Viveka ("discrimination of the permanent from the transient")	
Vairāgya ("non-attachment, dispassion")	
Śravaṇam ("listening")	
Mananam ("reflection")	
Nididhyāsanam ("continuous recognition")	
Mahāvākyas ("the great statements")	
Satsaṅga ("company of the true")	
Mumukṣutva ("burning desire for liberation")	

3 Fill the gaps

Solitude is the deliberate reduction of incoming ψ_x inputs so that the system can _____.

Discrimination without dispassion is intellectual _____.

The mahāvākyas are not the practice of śravaṇam; they are the moments in which the accumulated work of śravaṇam _____.

4 Spot the slip

Each statement contains a mistake. Correct it in the lines below.

"The path of knowledge means reading more and thinking harder until the teaching is clear."

"Going off alone is going off alone: tamasic withdrawal and sattvic solitude are the same thing."

Lesson 5.5: Transformation Through Knowledge, Solitude and Community (continued)

5 Draw it in your own way

The three-stage sequence (section 2.3). The lesson names three stages: śravaṇam, mananam and nididhyāsanam. Draw them in your own way, as a path, a staircase or three linked pictures, and label what each one is in the lesson's words: sustained reception of the teaching transmission; buddhi's systematic correction, one assumption at a time; continuous recognition. Add the reservoir that the lesson says śravaṇam builds.

Śravaṇam	Mananam	Nididhyāsanam

6 Apply

A further case, made up for this page. Maren has studied the Upaniṣads with a weekly group for some years. On a retreat the teacher closes a session with a single sentence, and for a few seconds Maren recognises the searching mind as what it was searching for. Back home the phone rings, the same worries return, and Maren decides the moment was lost and nothing was gained. Using section 2.3, say what the lesson says happened in that moment, why ordinary life seems to reassert itself, and what work the lesson names for the days that follow. Do not describe yourself.

7 Tracker

Module 5 builds its picture of transformation one practice family at a time. Write what Lesson 5.5 adds, in the lesson's own words: what the knowledge family works on, and how it differs from what the action-and-offering family of 5.4 does to h(t).

8 Check my notes

Key points for 5.5 are on the next page. There are no marks and no self-rating: compare your notes and decide for yourself.

5.5 Transformation Through Knowledge, Solitude and Community

Key points, not model answers. Compare them with your own notes and add what you missed in another colour.

The main ideas

- Section 1: where 5.4 lightens h(t) act by act, 5.5 dissolves the assumption that gives the filter its weight: that the contents of the equation (the vṛttis, the saṁskāric patterns, the standing tilt) are the practitioner.
- Sections 2.1 and 2.2: each genuine act of viveka loosens one identification, and the filter lightens. Discrimination without dispassion is "intellectual entertainment"; dispassion without discrimination is "dry suppression". Vairāgya loosens grasping "not by force of will" but by the recognition that drives viveka.
- Section 2.3, śravaṇam: prepared reception of a transmission, "not the consumption of information". The mahāvākyas are where its accumulated work concentrates: the recognition is partial and fades within seconds, but leaves a spiritual saṁskāra. Over years these form a reservoir that eventually tips the filter from net-obscuring to net-revealing.
- Section 2.3, mananam: buddhi examines assumptions one at a time (body, memories, doer). Without it "the path stalls".
- Section 2.3, nididhyāsanam: continuous recognition, the witness recognised in every cognition (Kena Upaniṣad II.4, as the lesson renders it: "Known in every cognition, that is known"). The lesson calls this jīvanmukti, liberation while living.
- Section 3.1: solitude, the deliberate reduction of incoming ψ_x, "does not produce the recognition". It is the inverse of tamasic withdrawal, the inability to engage: "One is collapse; the other is recalibration."
- Section 3.2: satsaṅga works by entrainment, with darśana the densest level; śaktipāta is "the descent of grace".
- Section 3.3: readiness needs sattvic buddhi, a lightened h(t) and genuine mumukṣutva: "honest structural prerequisites, not gatekeeping" (section 6). Where one is missing, the path lies through the preceding practice-families.
- Section 4: the Pratyabhijñā lens says the Śakti is the agent of viveka itself; "There is no second knower." Mananam is vikalpa-kṣaya. "The practitioner consents. The Śakti operates."

Terms

Viveka; vairāgya	Discrimination of the permanent from the transient; non-attachment or dispassion.
Śravaṇam; mananam; nididhyāsanam	Listening to the teaching transmission; reflection, one assumption at a time; continuous recognition.

Answers to the exercises

- **Gaps:** recalibrate; entertainment; concentrates.
- **Slips:** not reading more or thinking harder, but a specific kind of inquiry. Tamasic withdrawal and sattvic solitude look alike but are structurally inverse: collapse and recalibration.
- **Figure task:** reception with a reservoir growing; assumptions examined one at a time; recognition continuous.
- **Apply:** a spiritual saṁskāra was laid down; the recognition was partial, so ordinary operation returned; the work that follows is mananam, submitting the most active assumptions daily to viveka.
- **Tracker:** 5.4 lightens h(t) by changing the quality of what is deposited; 5.5 dissolves the assumption that gives h(t) its weight.

If anything here touches something difficult for you, please be gentle with yourself, and consider speaking with someone you trust or a qualified professional.

5.5 Transformation Through Knowledge, Solitude and Community: my notes and questions

A page for you. Nothing here is checked or collected.

What I want to remember

Questions I would like to ask

Where I notice this in my own life

Lesson 5.6: The Chain of Ascent and harmony of the Four Yogas

Aim: to see the four practice-families as one chain of ascent rather than four separate tools, and to hold the principle that keeps the chain honest: the practitioner follows the thread; the Power does the lifting. **Online:** Practice page and understanding check for 5.6 (vedanta.nz, My Journey).

1 In my own words

In three sentences, say what the lesson means by the tower, why ordinary effort cannot get out of it, and what draws the beetle upward in the story.

2 Terms to recall

Write each in your own words, then check the key points that follow this lesson. Brackets give the lesson's own gloss.

Term	In my own words
Grāhya and grāhaka ("objects" and "subjects")	
Iḍā and piṅgalā (the two lateral channels)	
Suṣumnā ("the central channel")	
Vāha-cheda (the silken thread)	
Śakti-saṅkoca-vikāsa (the pack thread)	
Vikalpa-kṣaya (the stout twine)	
Ādyanta-koṭi-nibhālana (the rope)	
Anugraha ("grace")	

3 Fill the gaps

The subject-object split is the seed; the world of separate things is the _____.

The lift comes from an attraction from above, which the tradition calls _____ (grace).

Karma yoga is not a link in the chain; it is the steadiness of the _____ that hold the chain.

4 Spot the slip

Each statement contains a mistake. Correct it in the lines below.

"If I strain harder against the walls of the tower, I will break out; the ascent is something my effort produces."

"The rope is the strongest thread, so the sensible way to begin is to take hold of the rope first."

Lesson 5.6: The Chain of Ascent and harmony of the Four Yogas (continued)

5 Draw it in your own way

The minister in the tower (section 2) and the four links (section 4). Draw the tower with the minister at the top and his wife below. Show the beetle with the silken thread, and the threads drawn up in the order the story gives them, naming what each stands for in Swami Vivekananda's explanation: breath, nerve currents, thoughts, Prāṇa. Use an arrow to show what draws the beetle upward, and mark where the chain ends.

The tower, the beetle and the threads

6 Apply

A further case, made up for this page. Leila sits for breath practice every morning. Through the rest of the day she is hurried, grasping and reactive, and she finds that the calm of the morning keeps slipping away. Using section 5, say what the lesson says about the hours outside formal practice, which family it assigns to that work, and where the lesson places it in relation to the chain. Do not describe yourself.

7 Tracker

Module 5 builds its picture of transformation one practice family at a time. Write what Lesson 5.6 adds, in the lesson's own words: how the four are related, and what keeps the chain honest.

8 Check my notes

Key points for 5.6 are on the next page. There are no marks and no self-rating: compare your notes and decide for yourself.

5.6 The Chain of Ascent and harmony of the Four Yogas

Key points, not model answers. Compare them with your own notes and add what you missed in another colour.

The main ideas

- Section 1: sūtra 3 says one Consciousness becomes manifold through the differentiation into mutually-adapted objects (grāhya) and subjects (grāhaka). “The subject-object split is the seed; the world of separate things is the tree.” The lesson calls this split the beat of the wave equation, sustained by the lateral flow between iḍā and piṅgalā.
- Section 2: ordinary effort cannot escape, since “every move made on its terms is one more turn of the same loop.” In the story the minister escapes by silken thread, pack thread, stout twine and rope, drawn up by a beetle following honey: breath, nerve currents, thoughts, Prāṇa, freedom. The rope “could not be grasped first”.
- The beetle is drawn, not driven: the lift is anugraha, grace. The practitioner sets the conditions; the lifting is done by what draws from above. “The ego cannot climb the tower; the ego is the tower.”
- Section 3: sūtra 17 names the remedy, the unfoldment of the central channel (suṣumnā). Sūtra 18 names four means; “and so on” signals they are representative, and saṅkoca and vikāsa count as one paired movement.
- Section 4: vāha-cheda rests attention at the natural turning-points of the breath, not forcing the breath to stop. Śakti-saṅkoca-vikāsa withdraws sense-energy toward its source while the senses keep working. Vikalpa-kṣaya dissolves thought-constructs through viveka, “not suppression”. Ādyanta-koṭi-nibhālana rests attention at the beginning and ending points of an arising.
- Section 5: the four means are “not four independent techniques to be selected by preference” but links of one chain, each presupposing and enabling the next. Action and offering (5.4) is not a link: “the steadiness of the hands that hold the chain.”
- Section 6: in Swami Vivekananda's emblem the waters stand for Karma, the lotus Bhakti, the rising sun Jñāna, the serpent Yoga and the awakened Kuṇḍalinī Śakti, and the swan the Paramātman. The four Yogas “do not produce the Swan”; the motto, “May that Swan, the Supreme Self, awaken our higher understanding”, is itself a statement of anugraha.

Terms

Iḍā; piṅgalā; suṣumnā	Two lateral channels (inward and cooling, outward and warming); the central channel.
The four threads	Silken thread, the breath; pack thread, the nerve currents; stout twine, the thoughts; rope, the psychic Prāṇa.
Anugraha	Grace: the higher sweetness drawing the system upward.

Answers to the exercises

- **Gaps:** tree; anugraha; hands.
- **Slips:** pushing harder only reinforces the walls; the lift is grace, and the ego is the tower. The rope could not be grasped first: begin with the silken thread.
- **Figure task:** tower, minister, beetle with honey above it; threads in order (breath, nerve currents, thoughts, Prāṇa); an arrow for what draws; freedom at the end.
- **Apply:** every action in those hours writes into h(t); action as offering (5.4) lightens it so the threads can be held; it is not a link but the steadiness of the hands.
- **Tracker:** one chain, not four techniques chosen by preference; the practitioner sets conditions and consents, and the lifting is grace.

If anything here touches something difficult for you, please be gentle with yourself, and consider speaking with someone you trust or a qualified professional.

5.6 The Chain of Ascent and harmony of the Four Yogas: my notes and questions

A page for you. Nothing here is checked or collected.

What I want to remember

Questions I would like to ask

Where I notice this in my own life

Lesson 5.7: From Temporal Ritam to Spectral Ritam

Aim: to see the two jobs the four practice-families have been doing at once, and how far the Fourier metaphor reaches and where it stops. **Online:** understanding check for 5.7 (vedanta.nz, My Journey).

1 In my own words

In three sentences, say what the temporal domain is, what the spectral domain is, and why the lesson says temporal Ritam is not a detour from spectral recognition.

2 Terms to recall

Write each in your own words, then check the key points that follow this lesson.

Term	In my own words
Temporal domain	
Spectral domain	
Temporal Ritam	
Spectral Ritam	
Suṣumnā	
Kuṇḍalinī	
The chakras	
The Fourier metaphor	

3 Fill the gaps

The practitioner does not _____ the substrate; the substrate has always been there.

Suṣumnā is the channel; kuṇḍalinī is the _____.

The standard Fourier transform is reversible, but when the contemplative domain-transformation completes, it does not _____.

4 Spot the slip

Each statement contains a mistake. Correct it in the lines below.

"The spectral domain is the real goal, so temporal Ritam is only a detour to get through as quickly as possible."

"The spectral domain is a very faint signal; with finer instruments and better experiments, science will one day detect it."

Lesson 5.7: From Temporal Ritam to Spectral Ritam (continued)

5 Draw it in your own way

The staircase (section 8). The lesson says the course is a staircase, "as precisely as the materials available to it permit". Its steps are the mind-wave equation, the Ritam Diagram, the guṇa algebra, the trebling cascade and the four practice-families. The stairs are not the roof, and yet the stairs and the roof are made of the same material. Draw a staircase and a roof in your own way. Label the steps the lesson names, say what the lesson says about the stairs and the roof, and show what they are made of.

The stairs and the roof

6 Apply

A further case, made up for this page. Dev reads that experienced meditators show less activity in the brain's default mode network, and says: "This proves the spectral domain is real." His friend Mere replies: "Then science has shown there is nothing beyond the brain." Using section 4 of the lesson, say what the finding does show, what it does not show, and why the lesson holds both lenses. Do not describe yourself.

7 Tracker

Module 5 follows how the four practice-families return anṛta to Ritam. Write what Lesson 5.7 adds to that thread, in the lesson's own words: the second job the families have been doing, and the sentence that names the course's own place in the architecture.

8 Check my notes

Key points for 5.7 are on the next page. There are no marks and no self-rating: compare your notes and decide for yourself.

5.7 From Temporal Ritam to Spectral Ritam

Key points, not model answers. Compare them with your own notes and add what you missed in another colour.

The main ideas

- Temporal Ritam, the equation functioning coherently in everyday life, is “real and primary” and sufficient for human flourishing. The four families have also been activating a single built-in capacity: “Not a new practice. The deeper layer of what the practices have already been doing.”
- The temporal domain is what the mind-wave equation describes. The spectral domain is “not a deeper layer of the signal but the awareness in which the signal is being read at all”: the {0} of the Ritam Diagram, in Vedantic language the Ātman.
- When anṛta is high, the spectral ground is occluded: the SNR (signal-to-noise ratio) is too low. As temporal Ritam is established the SNR rises. The practitioner does not produce the substrate, only the capacity to register it: temporal Ritam is “the preparation of the ground”.
- Suṣumnā is the channel, kuṇḍalinī the operator. A clear channel with no kuṇḍalinī movement produces no transformation; an active kuṇḍalinī with an obstructed channel produces difficulty rather than progress. The chakras are stations, not anatomical structures and not bypassable.
- At the ājñā centre, in Sri Ramakrishna's account, samādhi is available and the form of the Divine can be seen, but a partition remains. Seeing the form and being the source are not the same.
- The Fourier metaphor is faithful up to {9}. A standard transform is reversible; the completed contemplative transformation is not, and the Ātman is not a finite signal. At {0} “the framework releases its hold”.
- Science (default mode network findings, predictive processing, IIT, EEG) illuminates the temporal domain: “correlates, not proofs”. The spectral domain lies outside what third-person measurement can reach, a structural feature of the question and not a defect of science. Both lenses are required.
- The ascent is not something happening to the practitioner: the practitioner is the medium through which the Śakti's self-recognition occurs. “There is no shortcut. There is also, equally, no failure.”
- The stairs are not the roof, and yet the stairs and the roof are made of the same material.

Terms

{0}; {9}	{0}: the source-pole, the unmanifest ground, named as the spectral domain; not a signal. {9}: the integrating axis, the maximum-coherence state of the manifest spectrum.
Suṣumnā; kuṇḍalinī; chakras	The channel; the latent transforming power that acts as operator; the phase-transition stations.

Answers to the exercises

- **Gaps:** produce; operator; reverse.
- **Slips:** temporal Ritam is the preparation of the ground, and sufficient for flourishing. The spectral domain is not a deeper signal that better instruments could detect: it is what any signal is encountered in.
- **Figure task:** steps named (mind-wave equation, Ritam Diagram, guṇa algebra, trebling cascade, four practice-families); stairs are not the roof; both of the same material (brick, lime, brick-dust).
- **Apply:** a temporal-domain correlate; it does not establish the spectral claims, and a temporal method cannot settle them either, so neither conclusion follows. Both lenses are held.
- **Tracker:** the families restore temporal Ritam and quiet the system enough for spectral Ritam to begin to register; the stairs and the roof sentence.

If anything here touches something difficult for you, please be gentle with yourself, and consider speaking with someone you trust or a qualified professional.

5.7 From Temporal Ritam to Spectral Ritam: my notes and questions

A page for you. Nothing here is checked or collected.

What I want to remember

Questions I would like to ask

Where I notice this in my own life

Lesson 5.8: Arise, Awake: A Living Demonstration

Aim: to see how the course closes: one man's described afternoon read through the architecture of Lesson 5.7, Swami Vivekananda's reply, and why "Arise, awake" is read as a structural claim. **Online:** understanding check for 5.8 (vedanta.nz, My Journey).

1 In my own words

In three sentences, say who Manmatha Nath Ganguli was and what he asked, how the lesson says his experience came about, and what the lesson says Swami Vivekananda's reply is.

2 Terms to recall

Write each in your own words, then check the key points that follow this lesson.

Term	In my own words
Pratyāhāra	
Śaktipāta	
Entrainment	
Citiḥ svatantrā	
The Śakti	
Īśvarakoṭi (nityasiddha)	
{0}	
The "hypnotism"	

3 Fill the gaps

At the mind-wave equation register, śaktipāta is _____.

The lesson reads the account's fourth stage as a _____, not the completed transformation of Lesson 5.7.

"Arise, awake" is read as a structural claim: the substrate was never the _____.

4 Spot the slip

Each statement contains a mistake. Correct it in the lines below.

"Since everything is māyā, Swami Vivekananda's reply tells us that all engagement with the world should be given up."

"'Arise, awake' tells us to produce, by great effort, a state we do not yet have."

Lesson 5.8: Arise, Awake: A Living Demonstration (continued)

5 Draw it in your own way

The six stages (section 2.2). The lesson reads the account in six successive narrative stages: the inward turn (pratyāhāra); objects seen as vibrating; form dissolving, then voice without meaning, then void; the recognition of undivided Chit; the question to the teacher; the return. Draw the six in order as a simple path of frames, in your own way, with the lesson's short name under each. Mark the stage the lesson calls a glimpse and the one it calls the return. These are the stages of one man's described afternoon, not a ladder on which to place yourself.

Stage 1	Stage 2	Stage 3	Stage 4	Stage 5	Stage 6

6 Apply

A further case, made up for this page. Ana is about to begin work as a trainer. She says: “Swami Vivekananda plays with māyā from ever-free ground, so I can only teach once I can claim the same recognition.” Using section 3.2, say how the lesson describes the trainer's posture, what the trainer can do, and what the aim is not. Do not describe yourself.

7 Tracker

Module 5 follows how the four practice-families return anṛta to Ritam. Write what Lesson 5.8 adds to that thread, in the lesson's own words: how “Arise, awake” is read, what the practices have been, and the two statements about the architecture that the closing reflection says are true at once.

8 Check my notes

Key points for 5.8 are on the next page. There are no marks and no self-rating: compare your notes and decide for yourself.

5.8 Arise, Awake: A Living Demonstration

Key points, not model answers. Compare them with your own notes and add what you missed in another colour.

The main ideas

- The course closes by going from architecture to "a single human report": Manmatha Nath Ganguli, a disciple of Swami Vivekananda, asked him about māyā at Belur Math. The account is given in full first, then mapped.
- The lesson reads six successive stages: the inward turn (pratyāhāra); objects seen as vibrating; form dissolving, voice without meaning, void; the recognition of undivided Chit; the question to the teacher; the return. The stages describe that one afternoon, not a scale for the reader.
- The lesson calls the fourth stage "a glimpse, not the completed transformation of Lesson 5.7", which does not reverse. In the return the shell is known as a shell, and he honestly feels the difference between his teacher and himself.
- The experience was not produced by his own sādhana: the lesson names the mechanism śaktipāta, "the descent of the Śakti, the transmission". At the mind-wave equation register it is entrainment; at the Pratyabhijñā register it is the recognition of citiḥ svatantrā. "These are not two competing accounts."
- Swami Vivekananda's reply has three parts: the affirmation, the structural answer ("playing with māyā": free in it, engaged in it), and the alternative honestly named, the cave. The lesson reads it as the utterance of an Īśvarakoṭi; the trainee is not asked to classify themselves against it.
- The course is the stairs, made of the same material as the roof. The framework is māyā and an entirely faithful expression of the source: "one fact seen from two registers".
- For trainers the posture is a direction: "The aim is not to claim what one does not yet have."
- "Arise, awake" is "a structural claim made in the imperative mood". The "hypnotism" is the identification of the equation's contents with the ground itself. The practices are the de-hypnotisation: the SNR (signal-to-noise ratio) rises as the obstructions remove themselves.

Terms

Śaktipāta; entrainment	The descent of the Śakti; one wave becoming phase-locked to a high-coherence reference signal.
Citiḥ svatantrā; Śakti	Pure Consciousness as sovereign and free; the single power operating in teacher and student alike.
{0}; Īśvarakoṭi	The source-pole, not a term in the equation; an ever-free soul (nityasiddha).

Answers to the exercises

- **Gaps:** entrainment; glimpse; contents.
- **Slips:** the reply affirms that it is māyā, then says "playing with māyā": free in it, engaged in it; the cave is a genuine path, not the only one. "Arise, awake" is not "produce a state you do not have": the obstructions are removable.
- **Figure task:** six frames in the lesson's order, each named in the lesson's words; Stage 4 marked as a glimpse; Stage 6 as the return.
- **Apply:** the aim is not to claim what one does not yet have; the trainer holds the direction and serves from whatever clarity is currently available.
- **Tracker:** "Arise, awake" is a structural claim: the substrate was never the contents, the obstructions are removable, the practices are how they remove themselves. "The architecture is māyā, and the architecture is faithful. Both are true at once."

If anything here touches something difficult for you, please be gentle with yourself, and consider speaking with someone you trust or a qualified professional.

5.8 Arise, Awake: A Living Demonstration: my notes and questions

A page for you. Nothing here is checked or collected.

What I want to remember

Questions I would like to ask

Where I notice this in my own life